

Grants & Support for Minority Groups

Minority-owned businesses can tap into dedicated funding, certification, and support designed to level the playing field. Below are trusted national resources. Tick the box once you've checked each one.

⚠ BEFORE YOU START

Many of these programs are free to apply for and include coaching, not just money. Getting certified as minority-owned can also unlock contracts. Beware of anyone charging large fees for "minority grants."

1 Federal Support

Government programs built to help minority entrepreneurs grow.

☐ MBDA Business Centers

The Minority Business Development Agency helps minority firms access capital and contracts.

→ www.mbda.gov/businesscenters

☐ SBA 8(a) Business Development

A program helping disadvantaged businesses win federal contracts.

→ www.sba.gov/federal-contracting/contracting-assistance-programs/8a-business-development-program

2 Grants & Funding

Grant programs that frequently support minority-owned businesses.

☐ Hello Alice Grants

Frequent grants, many aimed at underrepresented founders.

→ helloalice.com/grants

☐ Comcast RISE

Grants and support, often for minority- and women-owned businesses.

→ www.comcastrise.com

☐ NMSDC — Supplier Certification

Get certified as a minority business to win corporate contracts.

→ nmsdc.org

3 Community Lenders

Lenders focused on underserved communities, often more flexible than banks.

☐ CDFIs

Mission-driven loans plus coaching for minority entrepreneurs.

→ www.cdfifund.gov/programs-training/certification/cdfi

☐ Kiva — 0% Microloans

0% interest loans up to \$15,000, no credit score needed.

→ www.kiva.org/borrow

4 Free Mentoring

Guidance tailored to your business and community.

☐ SCORE & SBDCs

Free mentoring and local advising for all entrepreneurs.

→ www.score.org

⚠ WATCH OUT FOR

Be cautious of “minority grant” offers that charge application or “processing” fees. Real programs through MBDA, SBA, and major foundations are free to apply for.

★ A TIP THAT HELPS

Getting certified as a minority-owned business (through NMSDC or your state) can open doors to corporate and government contracts worth far more than most grants.

NEED HELP WHERE YOU LIVE?

Need help where you live?

This guide covers national resources. For minority-business programs, certifications, and lenders in your area, use the personalized AI search or ask in the Questions area.

MY NOTES — WHO I CALLED, WHEN, AND WHAT THEY SAID
